

CRIMINAL JUSTICE

The Criminal Justice program in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences offers a Bachelor of Arts degree and a minor in Criminal Justice.

Your adventure begins with your academic advisor. Please contact cjsocadvising@iastate.edu for more information.

Students in this major will learn about the components of the juvenile and criminal justice systems, become acquainted with the issues affecting these systems, apply theoretical concepts to real-world phenomena, interface with criminal justice and social service providers, and plan an academic and/or applied career in criminal justice.

Student Learning Outcomes

Graduates of this program will:

- Understand theories of crime, victimization, and criminal justice (i.e., theories about social bonds, learning, social control, conflict, labeling, rehabilitation, alternatives to incarceration).
- Think critically about crime, victimization, and criminal justice (i.e., be able to apply, critique, compare, and integrate knowledge in the area).
- Understand how race/ethnicity, gender, wealth, and power are related to crime, victimization, and criminal justice.
- Understand and be able to use basic social science research methods, as well as those most relevant to the study of crime, victimization, and criminal justice.
- Be familiar with career paths in the criminal justice system and make career choices that best fit their career interests.
- Make appropriate decisions, think creatively and be able to express themselves in written and oral communication to supervisors and clients.

Degree Requirements

University Requirements

International Perspectives	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities	3
Total Credits	6

Communication Proficiency

According to the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencypolicytext>), students must demonstrate their communication proficiency by earning a grade of C or better in ENGL 1500 and ENGL 2500. In addition, majors must also take an advanced course in ENGL 3020 or ENGL 3090 or ENGL 3140 with a grade of C or better.

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3

LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
ENGL 3020	Business Communication	3
or ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	
or ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	

Total Credits 10

World Language and career proficiency

Students with 3 years of a single world language in high school are not required to take college-level world language.

2 semester of college-level world language	0-8
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OR

SPAN 1970	Accelerated Elementary Spanish (Students without 3 years of a single world language in high school are required to take college-level world language.)	
LAS 2030	Professional Career Preparation	1

Total Credits 1-9

General Education Coursework

Students must select from a variety of LAS approved general education courses in each area listed below. A full list of approved courses can be found at <https://las.iastate.edu/students/academics/general-education/>.

Arts and Humanities	12
Math	3
Natural Sciences	8
Social Sciences	6
Total Credits	29

Program of Study

A program of study that meets the needs and interests of the student and departmental requirements will be developed in consultation with the major advisor. Students must maintain a GPA of 2.0 or higher in their core courses.

SOC 1150	Orientation to Sociology	1
or CJ 1200	The Criminal Justice League Learning Community Seminar	
CJ 2400	Introduction to the U.S. Criminal Justice System	3
CJ 2410	Youth and Crime	3
CJ 2420	Criminology	3
CJ 3400	Deviant and Criminal Behavior	3
CJ 4020	White-Collar Crime	3
or CJ 4030	Criminal Offenders	
or CJ 4060	Gender and Crime	
CJ 4600	Criminal and Juvenile Justice Internship	3
Select one of the following courses		3
CJ 3200	American Judicial Process	

CJ 3320	Philosophy of Law
PHIL 3390	Liberty and Law in America
CJ 4040	Criminal Justice Policies
PSYCH 3830	Psychology and Law
Select 5 of the following courses	15
CJ 3200	American Judicial Process
CJ 3320	Philosophy of Law
CJ 3350	Race, Ethnicity, and the US Criminal Justice System
PHIL 3390	Liberty and Law in America
CJ 3510	Police and Society
CJ 3520	Punishment, Corrections, and Society
CJ 3540	Prevention of Crime and Delinquency
CJ 3600	Latinas and Victimization
CJ 4020	White-Collar Crime
CJ 4040	Criminal Justice Policies
CJ 4050	Drugs and Crime
CJ 4060	Gender and Crime
CJ 4100	Capital Punishment
CJ 4510	Contemporary Issues in Policing
CJ 4700	Ethical Issues in Criminal Justice
CJ 4840	Topical Studies in Criminal and Juvenile Justice
PSYCH 3830	Psychology and Law
Total Credits	37

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, **including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level**. You must also complete the LAS world language requirement and career proficiency requirement.

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Criminal Justice students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. Check (<http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/courses/div-ip-guide.html>) for a list of approved courses. Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

Criminal Justice, B.A.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
SOC 1150 or CJ 1200	1 CJ 1210	1
CJ 2400	3 CJ 2410	3
ENGL 1500	3 ENGL 2500	3
LIB 1600	1 Arts and Humanities Choice	3
Social Science Choice	3 Social Science Choice	3
Arts and Humanities Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	3
	14	16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CJ 3400	3 CJ 2420	3
World Languages/Elective	3-4 World Languages/Elective	3-4
Arts and Humanities Choice	3 Math Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 International Perspectives	3
Elective	3 Elective	3
LAS 2030	1	
	16-17	15-16

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CJ 4020, 4030, or 4060	3 Criminal Justice Special Topics	3
Criminal Justice Special Topics	3 Criminal Justice Special Topics	3
ENGL 3020, 3090, or 3140	3 Arts and Humanities Choice	3
Social Science Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	2
Elective	3 Elective	3
	15	14

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
CJ 3200, 3320, PHIL 3390, or PSYCH 3830	3 CJ 4600	3
Criminal Justice Special Topics	3 Criminal Justice Special Topics	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities	3 Elective	3
Elective	3 Elective	3
Elective	3 Elective	3
	15	15

Total Credits: 120-122

Special Topics choices: CJ 3200/POLS 3200; CJ 3320/PHIL 3320, PHIL 3390; CJ 3350, CJ 3510, CJ 3520, CJ 3540, CJ 3600, CJ 4020, CJ 4040, CJ 4050, CJ 4060, CJ 4100, CJ 4510, CJ 4700, CJ 4840*; and PSYCH 3830.

*May take up to 9 credits of CJ 4840 special topics.

Note: This is an example four-year plan. Your actual semester schedules may vary.

Criminal Justice Minor

The Criminal Justice minor offers an opportunity for students to learn about the components of the criminal and juvenile justice systems, to become acquainted with the issues and problems affecting these systems, to apply theoretical concepts to real world problems, and to plan a career in the criminal justice field.

Students who declare a minor in Criminal Justice are required to complete 18 total credits. Students may do up to nine credits of SOC 4600 but only three of those credits may be applied to the minor. Nine credits must be at the 3000 or 4000 level. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement. Students must have a minimum grade point average of 2.0 in courses for the minor.

CJ 2400	Introduction to the U.S. Criminal Justice System	3
CJ 4600	Criminal and Juvenile Justice Internship	3
Four additional C J courses		12
Total Credits		18

The Criminal Justice Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.